



RED BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Preliminary Notice

Date of Incident:	12/05/2022	Time of Incident:	15.00
Directorate / Region:	RMO Kimberley	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Near Miss	EQSafe Incident Number:	31371
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Safety Breach - Operator riding in Excavator Bucket.
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What Happened:

On 12th May a 36-tonne excavator and Bulldozer were being utilised to construct a low-level crossing. Five pipes were installed and the crossing was connected to the other side.

The dozer operator exited the machine to check the newly constructed site. The rock embankment began to dam water and water started overflowing over the crossing. While the dozer operator was on site, the quantity of water over the crossing increased to approximately 20 to 30mm.

The dozer operator requested a lift back to the dozer in the excavator bucket to avoid getting wet boots.

An anonymous source took a photo of the dozer operator riding in the excavator bucket and sent it to a Project Manager.



Worker in Operators bucket

A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk profile relating to:
Mobile Plant

Immediate Actions:
Please note that these are generic actions for all to consider in relation to this critical risk (and is not reflective of this specific incident):

- Reinforce the operator Duty of Care at Prestart meetings and the need for any passengers to be appropriately seated and secured regarding plant in line with legislation.
- Communicate the potential dangers associated with riding on mobile plant at the Pre-Start Meeting.
- Review risk assessments and mobile plant SWMS's to include unauthorised passengers..

Distribution of Notice:	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations
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